



AGENT WORKFLOW MAP · COMPANION TO THE BUILD SPEC

How an engagement runs

What runs, what it produces, who does it, and when

*The question this answers: **A client buys one module, a few, or all five — in any order. What actually happens in each case?***

PREPARED FOR

Fenwick How

Founder, The Aperture Method

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COMPANION DOCUMENT — The one-page overview of the system. The full technical build specification is in "Aperture Method — Agent Build Spec." An interactive version of this map is also saved as a browser page in the same folder.

The shape of it

Human-led, AI-enabled. Fenwick How at the helm, five specialist AI agents, one shared data foundation.

Every engagement starts with intake — one reconciled dataset that every agent reads directly. No agent depends on another having run. When several are purchased they enrich each other; none of them requires the others. Agents produce findings and artifacts; the recommendation and the call stay human.

What it means	
Fenwick first	Intake and acceptance start every engagement. Nothing downstream runs until he accepts the reconciled ledger.
6 SOPs	Each a self-contained piece of work with its own objective, inputs, steps, and quality checklist.
5 components	Purchasable individually — Insights, Analytics, Intelligence, Compass, Atlas — plus the Business X-Ray wedge.
1 intake store	The foundation. Every agent reads it directly; no agent reads another agent's output as a dependency.
100% reviewed	Nothing reaches a client without an explicit human release, recorded with person, timestamp, and diff.

What a client buys

The Business X-Ray is where most clients start, but any component can be bought alone, in any order. This is what happens in each case.

Purchase path	What runs	What the client gets
Business X-Ray only	SOP 01	The wedge, and where most clients start. Fixed fee, 2–3 weeks, low risk. A real prioritized diagnosis ending in a prescription — which components would move the needle, and in what order. Nothing else is required.
One component — Analytics	SOP 03	Marcus reads intake directly and delivers a complete Profit Map and scenario model. With no owner-validated constraint from Insights, he derives a working hypothesis from the financials and labels it as derived.
One component — Intelligence	SOP 04	Natalie runs the whole spatial arc from intake — geocode, segment, trade areas, penetration, site selection — and delivers the map plus a load-and-go ArcGIS package. Framed as where demand is, rather than what to do.
A few — X-Ray + Analytics + Compass	SOP 01, 03, 05	A common partial path. The X-Ray names the constraint, Analytics quantifies the money, Compass sequences the moves. Aria scores what is evidenced and lists what would need Intelligence to resolve.
Full Method	SOP 01–06	The complete arc. Roughly 10–14 weeks to the Focus Plan, then ongoing. Analytics and Intelligence run in parallel.
Atlas subscription only	SOP 06	Underrated. A client can subscribe to the Scoreboard without ever buying an engagement — Thomas baselines on their own stated goals, establishes period zero, and runs the monthly cadence.

The arc

SOP	Segment	Owner	The question it answers	Deliverable	Duration
00 Intake & Acceptance	Prerequisite	Fenwick	“Do the numbers tie, and what is missing?”	Reconciled data store + Gap Memo	Continuous
01 Business X-Ray	Entry / wedge	Lena (AI)	“Where do we stand, and what do we fix first?”	X-Ray report + Aperture Score	2–3 wk
02 Aperture Insights	01 · Understand	Lena (AI)	“What is happening?”	Validated constraint, success measures, plan	2–3 wk
03 Aperture Analytics	02 · Quantify	Marcus (AI)	“Why is it happening?”	Profit Map + scenario model	3–4 wk
04 Aperture Intelligence	03 · Reveal	Natalie (AI)	“What opportunities does it reveal?”	Customer & Market Map + ArcGIS package	2–3 wk
05 Aperture Compass	04 · Navigate	Aria (AI)	“Where should we go next?”	Opportunity Matrix + Focus Plan	1–2 wk
06 Aperture Atlas	05 · Perform	Thomas (AI)	“How do we sustain and improve results?”	Live Scoreboard + KPI system	Ongoing

Atlas is a loop, not an end

Fresh data re-opens the next constraint and can trigger a new component engagement. The arc restarts rather than finishing.

Who does what

Marker	Who	Examples
FENWICK	Fenwick. Irreducible.	Kickoff, the 3–5 interviews, naming the constraint, every readout, setting the cadence.
AGENT	The model reasons, drafts, triangulates.	Scoring the seven lenses, triangulating interview claims against the ledger, interpreting a site model, drafting a report.
TOOL	Deterministic code. The number of record.	Reconciliation, the Profit Map, break-even and sensitivity, trade areas, the weighted matrix, the Aperture Score composite.
HYBRID	The agent proposes, a person decides.	Constraint candidates, success measures, component sequencing, Now/Next/Later, KPI definitions.

The split that matters

Agents compress the mechanical 80%. They do not touch the judgment 20%. Every agent produces findings and artifacts, never conclusions and advice — the recommendation and the call stay with you, because that is the mile the client is paying for.

When it happens

Elapsed weeks for a full Method engagement. These durations are calendar-bound by client scheduling, not by analysis time — which is exactly what the agents change. A standalone purchase collapses to its own bar.

Segment	Weeks	Runs in parallel with
Business X-Ray	0 – 3	—
Aperture Insights	3 – 6	—
Aperture Analytics	6 – 10	Aperture Intelligence
Aperture Intelligence	6 – 9	Aperture Analytics
Aperture Compass	10 – 12	— (needs both above)
Aperture Atlas	12 onward	Ongoing

What the 2–3 weeks of an X-Ray actually is

A 45–60 minute kickoff, a data-return wait on the client, 3–5 interviews of 45 minutes each that have to be scheduled, and a 60-minute readout. Those are irreducibly human. What agents compress is everything between the meetings — so the duration stays the same and your hands-on time inside it drops from most of two weeks to a day of review. That is what lets you run five or ten at once.

SOP 01 · Business X-Ray

Lena · AI Agent · The Strategist · 2–3 weeks

A structured, seven-lens read of the whole business, the single biggest constraint holding it back, and an Aperture Score baseline the client can track.

Process

Step	Who	Output
1 Kickoff & data request	FENWICK	Signed-off scope
2 Assemble & sanity-check	TOOL	Reconciled model
3 Seven-lens diagnostic	AGENT	7 scored lenses
4 Interviews	FENWICK	Triangulated findings
5 Score & weight	TOOL	Aperture Score
6 Name the binding constraint	HYBRID	The #1 constraint
7 Synthesis & report	AGENT	X-Ray report
8 Readout	FENWICK	Client decision

Quality gates — each becomes an executable assertion

- Every headline number reconciles to the client's financials
- Each of the seven lenses has evidence, not just an opinion
- The Aperture Score is reproducible from recorded inputs and weights
- The #1 constraint is singular, specific, and defensible
- The report is readable by a non-analyst
- The prescription names concrete next components and why
- All PII handled per the data-security standard

Standalone behaviour

The standalone product by design. It needs nothing but intake.

SOP 02 · Aperture Insights

Lena · AI Agent · The Strategist · 2–3 weeks

The shared, quantified baseline the rest of the Method builds on — confirms or produces the X-Ray, then frames the full engagement.

Process

Step	Who	Output
1 Confirm or produce the X-Ray	AGENT	X-Ray on file
2 Validate the constraint with the owner	FENWICK	Constraint agreed in writing
3 Define success measures	HYBRID	Baselines + targets
4 Sequence the components	HYBRID	Engagement plan
5 Readout & mobilize	FENWICK	Plan approved

Quality gates — each becomes an executable assertion

- The constraint is agreed with the owner in writing
- Success measures are specific, baselined, and trackable
- Each downstream component has its data prerequisites listed
- Phase-gate dates and decision criteria are set

Standalone behaviour

The engagement-opening phase. Bought without a prior X-Ray, it runs the X-Ray SOP first.

SOP 03 · Aperture Analytics

Marcus · AI Agent · The Analyst · 3–4 weeks

Exactly where the business makes and loses money — by product, location, and customer — plus a scenario model so decisions can be tested before they are made.

Process

Step	Who	Output
1 Build the financial model	TOOL	Reconciled model
2 Map profitability	TOOL	Profit Map
3 80/20 & cost structure	TOOL	Ranked drivers
4 Break-even & sensitivity	TOOL	Sensitivity ranges
5 Scenario / forecast model	AGENT	Interactive model
6 Synthesis & readout	AGENT	Prioritized moves

Quality gates — each becomes an executable assertion

- The model reconciles to the client's financials to the dollar
- Cost allocations are documented and defensible
- Profit cuts are shown only at the level the data supports — no false precision
- Scenario assumptions are explicit and adjustable
- Recommendations tie back to the #1 constraint

Standalone behaviour

Bought alone, Marcus derives a working constraint hypothesis from the financials and labels it “derived — not owner-validated.”

SOP 04 · Aperture Intelligence

Natalie · AI Agent · The Explorer · 2–3 weeks

Who the best customers are, where they are, and where the next ones will come from — market, customers, and competitors over real geography.

Process

Step	Who	Output
1 Assemble & geocode	TOOL	De-identified layer
2 Customer analytics	TOOL	Segments + CLV
3 Trade-area & drive-time	TOOL	Demand concentration
4 Market penetration & competition	TOOL	Competitive map
5 Site-selection modeling	AGENT	Ranked areas
6 ArcGIS package & readout	AGENT	GIS package

Quality gates — each becomes an executable assertion

- Geocoding accuracy checked; unmatched records reported, not hidden
- PII removed from the analysis layer after geocoding
- Trade areas and drive-times use documented, sensible parameters
- The growth recommendation is backed by the client's own demand data
- The ArcGIS package opens cleanly with the layer guide

Standalone behaviour

Bought alone, Natalie runs the full spatial arc from intake and frames output as “where demand is,” not “what to do.”

SOP 05 · Aperture Compass

Aria · AI Agent · The Navigator · 1–2 weeks

Everything the earlier phases surfaced, turned into a prioritized, board-ready plan — scored, ranked, and sequenced.

Process

Step	Who	Output
1 Consolidate the opportunity set	AGENT	Master list
2 Score in the weighted matrix	TOOL	Scored matrix
3 Stress-test against scenarios	TOOL	Robust ranking
4 Sequence into Now / Next / Later	HYBRID	Sequenced roadmap
5 Build the Focus Plan & readout	AGENT	Approved Focus Plan

Quality gates — each becomes an executable assertion

- Every opportunity is scored on the same criteria and weights
- The ranking is reproducible and the weights are recorded
- The sequence puts the constraint first; expansion is gated on evidence
- Each item has an owner, milestones, and dependencies
- The plan is genuinely board-ready — one page tells the story

Standalone behaviour

Bought alone, Aria generates candidates from intake, scores what is evidenced, and lists what would need Analytics or Intelligence to resolve.

SOP 06 · Aperture Atlas

Thomas · AI Agent · The Operator · ongoing

An always-on executive Scoreboard of the few KPIs that matter, plus the cadence that keeps the plan honest quarter after quarter.

Process

Step	Who	Output
1 Define the KPIs	HYBRID	KPI definitions
2 Wire the data	TOOL	Validated feed
3 Build the Scoreboard	TOOL	Published Scoreboard
4 Set the cadence	FENWICK	Cadence live
5 Re-score & steer	AGENT	Signal Brief + next constraint

Quality gates — each becomes an executable assertion

- Every KPI has a definition, source, target, owner, and cadence
- Dashboard numbers reconcile to the source systems
- Access is least-privilege and documented
- The re-scored Aperture Score uses the identical baseline method
- The client can operate the Scoreboard themselves — it is theirs to keep

Standalone behaviour

Subscribable on intake alone. Without a Focus Plan, Thomas baselines on the client's stated goals and establishes period zero.

Where to go next

Document	What is in it
Aperture Method — Agent Build Spec	The full technical specification: data model, run contract, prompt architecture, gates, privacy layer, Aperture Score spec, a profile page and build spec per agent, repository layout, and the phased roadmap.
aperture-agent-workflow.html	An interactive version of this map. Pick a purchase path and click any SOP to expand its steps and gates.
The Aperture Method — Method SOPs	The source manual. The agents load these chapters verbatim, so this document remains the single home of the procedure.

The Aperture Method™ · Understand · Quantify · Reveal · Navigate · Perform